

Prayers for our World and the Church

16th August 2026

Psalm 40:5

[5] Many, O Lord my God, are the wonders which You have done, And Your thoughts toward us; There is none to compare with You. If I would declare and speak of them, They would be too numerous to count.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that we can take courage from the evidence of Your great power and wisdom in Your Creation. We can still express our wonder at Your majesty and grandeur revealed in this world, even though we know it has been marred by sin and the curse. But we can also praise You for Your great love and mercy in sending Jesus to redeem us, and to reverse the curse.

We thank You that we have been forgiven and have been set free from sin. We thank You that Your thoughts are always towards us and not against us, even when You must chastise and discipline us.

We thank You for the daily presence of the Holy Spirit, coming alongside to guide us, and to enable us to resist temptation, to open our minds to Your Word, and to grant us wisdom as we live in this fallen world.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We pray for this world where rebellious mankind has turned away from You, and still refuses to turn back. In so many places and so many ways, Your people are subjected to persecution. We pray against the ugly rise of anti-semitism in recent years, and we pray for the peace of Jerusalem, as Your Word calls us to do. Yet we recognise that no nation is perfect or fully obeys You, and much that might be called good is spoiled by the effects of sin. We pray against the ongoing terrorist attacks against Christians in nations such as Nigeria, Pakistan, and elsewhere, much of which is never reported.

We remember Lord, that Jesus warned there would always be wars and rumours of wars, and we know that the kingdom of heaven operates on different principles. We thank You that the gospel continues to spread, despite what we see and hear in the news. We pray for the many churches where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, and ask that You would strengthen Your people to stand boldly, but with grace, against the lies so popular today.

Ashburton

We pray as we work here at Ashburton, that You would continue to lead and guide us in the work of the Kingdom. As we read Your Word we pray for the True Light to enliven what we read so that we leave our old ways behind and we change to live more like Jesus, bringing grace and mercy to one another, and to those we meet in our daily walk.

We pray for the Session, for Douglas our Moderator, for the Board and for the Selection Committee, all of whom work on our behalf, seeking Your wisdom, and working to do Your will, so that Your purposes prevail in everything we do. We pray for ourselves to support them in their work, as they serve on our behalf. We also give thanks for the ongoing support of Presbytery as we await the decisions of the Exit Students Committee.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Joan Milne, Russell, Diane, Levi and others affected by illness or injury. We remember those of our fellowship who are away, and pray You would grant them safe travel and rich fellowship, and that they would return refreshed and in good spirit.

We thank You for Your Word, the sure foundation of our faith, and for John Huynh as he preaches today. We pray that we would be diligent hearers and do-ers of Your Word, making the most of the means of grace. We thank You also for the Surrey Hills congregation and their support for us here during our vacancy.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.